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Housing Recovery and
Reconstruction Platform
BULLETIN
25 November 2019



The four-room, Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry (SMM) house of Mr. Resham Bahadur Dhimi of Ward no. 2, Annapurna Rural Municipality, Kaski District is undergoing retrofitting process of his house. The house is being retrofitted with technical and financial support from Build Change/UNOPS. Strong back technology has been applied for this retrofitting. Resham has received the first tranche of NPR 50,000.00 of GoN retrofitting grant.

Featured Technical Staff Person



Shambhu Raj Karna

*Engineer, Manahari Rural
Municipality, Makwanpur*

This month's Bulletin features Mr. Shambhu Raj Karna, technical staff. He is originally from Sarlahi district. He has been working as an Engineer in Manahari Rural Municipality in Makawanpur district since April 2016 and is also a reconstruction focal person at the municipality.

Having worked at Manahari Rural Municipality for more than three and a half years, he has experienced various issues and challenges in the reconstruction work.

Shambu is also leading a Retrofit Task Force at Manahari Rural Municipality. He shares that proper procedural design on retrofitting, training on retrofitting to the technical persons would help to move retrofitting initiatives in a smooth way.

He is not only satisfied to see the reconstruction picking up but happy to see the increased awareness among the people about the government policy and standards/guidelines for constructing earthquake resistant houses.

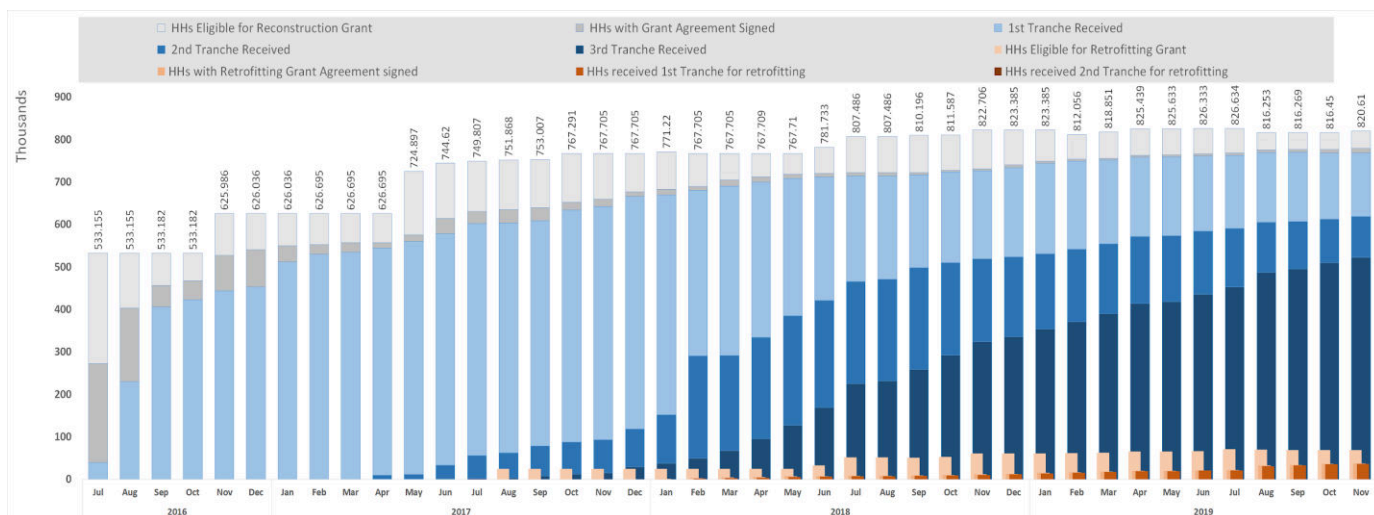
Highlights

- NRA organized a symposium on livelihood efforts in earthquake-affected areas: Evidence and experiences from partners perspective.
- CLPIU-Building organized Training of Trainers (TOT) on earthquake resistant building construction in Dhankuta for the NRA engineers from Dhankuta, Sanhuwasava and Bhojpur.
- International Conference Organizing Committee's first meeting held at NRA.
- An Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) has been initiated and 2 meetings have been held at HRRP.
- A Retrofitting Working Group (RWG) formed both at National and District level.
- Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons' training curriculum finalized and planning process for the TOT training underway by World Bank (WB) jointly with CLPIU-Building.
- A seminar was held on 'Earthquake Hazard Studies for Nepal/Himalayan Region

National Updates

[NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 25 November:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	30 September	24 October	25 November
Total No. Eligible HHs	816419	816450	820610
HHs Enrolled	776888	776916	779725
HHs Received 1st Tranche	767449	768555	768632
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	624867	628458	632558
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	607937	612397	618928
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	3590	3876	3896
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	525601	533915	542193
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	498638	509886	523208
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	1981	2008	2133
Houses Completed	464871	471691	480246
HHs with Completion Certificate	38228	42103	47486
Retrofit Grant	30 September	24 October	25 November
Total No. Eligible HHs	69581	69620	69613
HHs Enrolled	33647	36546	37224
HHs Received 1st Tranche	33155	36097	36491
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	28	29	31



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMaLI CLPIU data as of 25 November 2019.

NRA organized a two day workshop on private housing at Hotel View Bhirkuti in Lalipur, 25-26 November 2019:

NRA organized a two-day preparatory workshop on private housing reconstruction as part of preliminary preparation for the upcoming international conference planned for 2020 to identify areas of research papers in a standard framework and expected product for sharing with national and international reconstruction stakeholders. The workshop aims at discussing and finalizing thematic papers and potential writers with clear roles and responsibilities including a timeline for the submission of research paper to the organizing committee of this international conference. For more information, please contact NRA Executive Member **Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha:** cbshrestha@nra.gov.np or Deputy Spokesperson, **Mr. Manohar Ghimire:** mghimire@nra.gov.np

NRA organized symposium on livelihood efforts in earthquake affected areas: Evidences and experiences from partner perspective, 21-22 November 2019 :

NRA organized a symposium on “livelihood efforts in the earthquake affected areas: evidences and experiences from partner perspective” with an objective to develop, document and disseminate some experiences and evidences of integrating livelihood in the housing reconstruction program. Key partner organizations shared their livelihood program activities highlighting their livelihood strategies, approaches, outcomes, including lessons learned and best practices adopted within the framework of owner-driven housing reconstruction program of Government of Nepal. NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyewali and NRA Secretary, Mr. Shiva Hari Sharma addressed the symposium participants stating that it is very important to validate the work outcomes including financial audit report through local bodies and beneficiaries at the local level. NRA Executive Committee Member, Dr. Bishnu Bhandari encouraged and motivated every PO to document best practices and lessons learnt of livelihood integration in the recovery and reconstruction program. [Click Here](#) for the PO presentations for your reference. For more information please contact NRA Executive Member **Dr. Bishnu Bhandari:** bishnunws@gmail.com

Training of Trainers (TOT) on earthquake resistant building construction for the NRA engineers, 19-24 November, 2019:

A seven-day Training of Trainers (TOT) on earthquake resistant building construction for the newly recruited NRA engineers was conducted from 19-24 November 2019 in Dhankuta. The training was organized by CLPIU-Building with technical support from HRRP and NSET. There were 37 engineers from Dhankuta, Bhojpur and Sankhuwasabha districts. This is the 16th of its series organized by CLPIU-Building. The topic of the training included earthquake basics, earthquake resistant design and construction philosophy, National Building Code (NBC), inspection process of reconstructed building typologies, retrofitting etc.

International Conference Organizing Committee’s first meeting held at NRA, 15 November 2019:

The first meeting of the organizing Committee on International Conference on Nepal’s recovery and reconstruction was held on 15 November 2019 at NRA, Singha Durbar. The meeting was presided by the NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyewali who is also the Chairperson of the Organizing Committee. The conference aims at sharing accomplishments, lessons learnt and best practices adopted during Nepal’s earthquake recovery and reconstruction process to the national and international reconstruction stakeholders. NRA has requested its partners to submit abstracts of research papers primarily on housing, heritage, livelihood themes to be submitted to potential authors and reviewers so that standard research papers could be shared during the international conference tentatively planned for November 2020. For more information, please contact NRA Executive Member **Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha:** cbshrestha@nra.gov.np or Deputy Spokesperson, **Mr. Manohar Ghimire:** mghimire@nra.gov.np

An Urban Technical Working Group meeting, 13 November 2019:

An Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) has been formed to advocate and strategize for more effective, safe and dignified urban recovery. The UR-TWG held its first session on 13th November, wherein the members discussed on issues surrounding urban reconstruction. They also discussed their interest/experience working in urban recovery, along with the group’s tentative work plan and steps forward. A survey has been floated out amongst the members to finalize the urban issues to be prioritized and brought into focus. In parallel, the group is going to collectively carry out qualitative and

quantitative research on prioritizing urban issues in order to then implement evidence-based advocacy and strategies. In a second session on 20th November, the UR-TWG finalized its TOR and further developed a work plan. Members of the UR-TWG include JICA, Lumanti, World Vision, Kathmandu Metropolitan City, NSET, CRS and DRCN. The next meeting will be held on **28 November, 2019** with the agenda of detailing out the qualitative research methodology and discussing the results of the survey currently being carried out. Kindly contact **Bhubaneswari Parajuli** techcord.national@hrrpnepal.org for further information and contribution to the urban recovery process.

Partner sharing session: Retrofitting data analysis, 21 November 2019: A sharing session on 'Retrofitting Data Analysis' was organized by HRRP on 21st November at HRRP. This sharing session was mainly on retrofitting cost based on data provided by three organizations working on retrofitting. Apart from retrofitting cost analysis, the current status of retrofitting, communication strategy, implementation plan, ToR for Retrofitting task force, strategy and next steps were discussed at the session. In total 19 participants (12 Male & 7 Females) from NSET, Build Change, UNDP, ASF, CRS & CRATERre including HRRP staff participated in the sharing session. A Retrofitting Working Group (RWG) comprising of representatives from five interested organizations that include NSET, CRS, Build change, UNDP and HRRP was formed to support retrofitting task of the GoN.

Similarly, CLPIU-Building has instructed all the DLPIU-Building Offices in the 20 districts (Kathmandu, Lalitpur, Bhaktapur, Makwanpur, Kavre, Sindhupalchowk, Dolakha Ramechhap, Okhaldhunga, Sindhuli, Nuwakot, Rasuwa, Gorkha, Dhading, Lamjung, Palpa, Kaski, Baglung, Dhankuta and Chitwan) for the formation of Retrofitting Task Forces at the district level and Municipal Level. The district level retrofitting task force is led by the District Support Engineer (DSE) with a focal engineer and locally based engineer. Similarly, the Municipal level retrofit task force is led by an engineer with knowledge on structural analysis with a general basic knowledge about retrofitting and a locally based engineer as a member. HRRP district teams are part of the retrofitting task force in respective districts. The main responsibilities of these retrofitting task force include: verification of the retrofitting beneficiaries at municipal level, design, analysis and cost estimate of the common typologies, field level coordination, awareness raising on retrofitting including survey of the retrofitted HHs in the given format and preparation of reconstruction action plan among others. [Click here](#) for the letter for further reference. Kindly contact **Bhubaneswari Parajuli** techcord.national@hrrpnepal.org if you are interested in joining the RWG at the national level.

Training Curriculum for Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons in the process of finalization, 4 November: The World Bank (WB) organized a half day sharing session on November 4, 2019 at Hotel Royal Singi to review and finalize training curriculum for Social Mobilizers (SM) and Mobile Masons (MM) and to update on the status of the recruitment process for SM and MM that are being recruited by DLPIU-Building at local level to be part of the Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) teams to expedite the recovery and reconstruction process. During the sharing session DLPIU Building and GMAI Chiefs from the districts updated on the recruitment process of SM and MM that is expected to end by the end of November. The members of the curriculum development task force briefly presented on the curriculum development status and the product that have been submitted to WB for further review and feedback. WB and CLPIU-Building through the support of identified Resource Persons (RPs) will be delivering training to all the selected SMs and MMs in close coordination and collaboration with DLPIUs (Building and GMAI) at the district level.

Currently about 250 SMs and 1000 MMs are being recruited by the DIPIU-Building based on the [recruitment policy guideline-2076](#) developed by CLPIU-Building. The WB initiated development of training curricula focusing on social mobilization aspect for SM and MM in April 2019 with the support from Partner Organizations (POs) by forming three task groups responsible for Senior Engineer (SE), SM and MM. More than 25 participants representing various government and non-government organizations participated in the sharing session including Project Director and Deputy Project Director of CLPIU Building, DLPIU Building and GMAI Chiefs from all 14 earthquake affected districts,

representative from POs and members of the task groups. HRRP has been contributing in developing training curriculum in all three task groups as well as providing coordination support to the task group led by CLPIU Building and the WB.

A seminar on ‘Earthquake Hazard Studies for Nepal/Himalayan Region’, 1 November 2019: GoN-Department of Mines and Geology (DMG), United States Geological Survey (USGS), Global Earthquake Model (GEM) Foundation and National Society for Earthquake Technology (NSET) jointly organized a seminar on “Earthquake Hazard Studies for Nepal/Himalayan Region” on 1 November 2019 at Hotel Manaslu, Lazimpat. The seminar focused on understanding various studies related to earthquake hazards in Nepal/Himalaya region and discussing US and Global Earthquake Hazard Studies. The main objective of the seminar was to understand the ongoing efforts of earthquake monitoring and hazard assessment in Nepal and identifying the need of capacity building for Nepalese stakeholders, and potential collaborative efforts for organizing earthquake hazards studies in Nepal. The event also aimed to bring together stakeholders and experts from related fields to incite discussions on a common scientific platform for long term hazard assessment studies and its regular update in Nepal. Various research papers were presented and shared during the event. The participants in the seminar included representatives from DMG, USGS, the GEM Foundation, USAID, NAST, UNRCO, NRA, NEC, NRAP, SONA, HRRP, IOE (TU), Build Change, SCAEF. Overall, the program provided a good opportunity for stakeholders and national/international experts in the field of hazard assessment to come to a consensus on the need for a common forum that would establish a mechanism for future hazard studies using the latest technology and a dynamic system to update it continuously.

Rastriya Banijya Bank Limited and UKaid Sakcham Access to Finance Project signed Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to facilitate subsidized loan process, 25 October 2019: The Rastriya Banijya Bank Limited and UKaid Sakcham Access to Finance Project signed an MoU on 25th October in presence of NRA CEO Mr. Sushil Gyewali. The programme aims at facilitating the subsidized loan process for the earthquake affected beneficiaries in Dhading and Gorkha who took the first tranche of private housing reconstruction grant but were not able to reconstruct their houses due to financial constraints. The beneficiaries are expected to have easy access to finance and are able to take a loan of upto NPR 300,000 for a maximum period of 5 years according to a [subsidized loan policy issued by the Nepal Rastra Bank](#) last year. In this scheme, the bank or the financial institution provide loans at the interest rate of 2% above their base rates, and 5% of the interest is borne by the government as subsidy.

District & Municipal Updates

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Dolakha (6 Nov), Lamjung (12 Nov) and Nuwakot (14 Nov). Municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Bhaktapur, Kathmandu, Kavrepalanchok, Kaski, Lalitpur, Lamjung, Makwanpur, Nuwakot, Okhaldhunga, Ramechhap, Sindhuli, Sindhupalchok, Solukhumbu & Syangja. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Dolakha**, the meeting focused on retrofit, PA collection and duplication. DLPIU building has planned to conduct retrofit of five houses within each municipality. The meeting decided to collect the details of retrofit households at each ward. The field engineers were requested to collect the remaining partnership agreement forms and submit to GMaLI for digitization. GMaLI requested focal persons of municipalities to coordinate with local authorities and partner organizations to verify the household that have received reconstruction support grant from the government and the POs to minimize the duplication of tranche. GMaLI to circulate the details of households in reconstruction grant list to the local authorities such that all concerned know the real status of the households.
- In **Lamjung**, District Facilitation committee coordination meeting was held on 12 Nov 2019. The meeting discussed on the NRA grant deadline of Kartik 2076 (mid Nov 2019) to receive the second tranche by the households who have received the first tranche. The meeting decided to request NRA to extend the deadline since the reconstruction started late in the 18 districts. The meeting also decided to request NRA to disburse the remaining tranche to the families who constructed houses before the mobilization of technical persons and have taken first and/or second tranche.
- In **Nuwakot**, the meeting was organized between GMaLI, STFC, UNOPS. UNOPS briefed on its project “Visualization Village” where UNOPS with support from Embassy of India is providing socio technical assistance to 23,088 earthquake affected households to rebuild houses. In addition, UNOPS is also providing on the job training to five landless families who are starting reconstruction on land purchased with support from GMaLI. GMaLI suggested UNOPS to build environment friendly visualization village. Regarding the economically poor households that have not been able to start reconstruction, UNOPS will provide the details of such households in their working areas. UNOPS will also provide a list of households in their working areas that have not received any tranche.
- In **Kathmandu, ward 2, Kageshwori Manohara Municipality (11 Nov 2019)**, there are eight households under retrofit grant that have not signed the partnership agreement with the government due to weak financial condition. Similarly, eight households under reconstruction grant have not started reconstruction due to insufficient money. Regarding the non-compliant cases, most houses in the ward lack earthquake resistant elements and some are hybrid structures that do not meet the NRA requirements. District Support Engineer confirmed to check these houses to address the issues.
- In **Kavrepalanchok, meetings took place in Ward 1, MandanDeupur (22 Oct 2019), Wards 3, 8 & 9, Temal Rural Municipality (11 – 12 Nov 2019)**, one of the major discussions was on time taken for the hearing of the legal appeal (Punarabedan) cases where the people have applied to be included in the list of households eligible for Government financial assistance. Deadline set by NRA for taking the second tranche by those who have taken first tranche by Kartik 2076 (mid Nov 2019) has caused confusion among the people. Many families whose houses were resurveyed but have not been addressed have been visiting the ward offices to confirm if they need to meet the deadline or not. The ward offices have suggested a simple way of beneficiary conversion in case of deaths, as it usually takes a long time delaying reconstruction. Some of the tasks for ward offices decided during the meetings were: to maintain the database on reconstruction update of each

beneficiary, to publish the NRA grant deadline notice at ward offices and to communicate about the retrofit awareness program to the retrofit beneficiaries.

- In **Lalitpur, Ward 14, Godawari Municipality (8 Nov 2019)**, out of the 482 households that have taken first tranche, only 65 have taken second tranche. The main reason for the gap between first and second tranche is largely due to the houses constructed immediately after the earthquake which are non-compliant. Family issues, multiple ownership of the house, eccentric footing between quake damaged and non-damaged houses are also the issues delaying reconstruction. There are families who do not have land ownership documents as they have not been transferred from their grandparents to them. These families have not been able to start reconstruction. Similarly, families residing in landlords' and public lands without any legal documents have also not been able to start reconstruction.
- In **Bhaktapur (13 Nov 2019)**, Retrofitting Task Group under DSE, DLPIU-Building Bhaktapur organized "Orientation on Retrofitting Measures" to the retrofit beneficiaries of Bhaktapur Municipality. Some of the issues reported were that most of the households that took the first retrofit tranche have used the amount in minor repairing of the houses without following proper retrofit measures. Four storey, BMM houses have also been done repairing where cracks are still visible. There are cases of multiple beneficiaries who wish to retrofit the house but only one of them have done the partnership agreement with the government. DSE and M&E Specialist clarified the processes of conversion retrofitting to reconstruction and oriented on retrofitting measures.
- In **Ramechhap, Wards 7,8 & 9, Ramechhap Municipality (18 – 22 Nov 2019)**, it was reported that most of the vulnerable households in these wards have reconstructed their houses. However, most are one-room houses. In ward 9, there was an issue where one of the beneficiaries built a house in another district, in Marin Rural Municipality of Sindhuli. He got the first and second tranches from Ramechhap but due to change in NRA policy, has not got the third tranche as the municipality where he constructed a new house is not adjacent to Ramechhap Municipality. The provision of grant withdrawal from the bank if the beneficiaries do not withdraw within 35 days has caused difficulty especially to the people with disability. Some Ward Chiefs also expressed concern regarding the retrofitting of SMM houses. However, they welcomed the retrofitting of demo houses conducted by Build Change/UNOPS, as this might encourage people to retrofit their houses.
- In **Sindhupalchok**, meetings took place in **Ward 5, Indrawati Rural Municipality (7 Nov 2019) & Helambu Rural Municipality (19 Nov 2019)**. In Indrawati RM, the main discussion was on landless issues in presence of CSRC, Sindhu Uththan Kendra and landless families. The process of purchasing land and the necessary documents the landless families must submit to purchase lands were discussed during the meeting. In Helambu RM, it was reported that the reconstruction of private housing is progressing well, except that of landless and quake-displaced families. There are 66 displaced households but only 12 of them have been included in the NRA list. Most of the households in the municipality have received the third tranche, but completion certificate distribution has not been done. One of the major concerns was regarding the repair of the monastery while it was reported that it has been severely damaged which needs reconstruction.
- In **Lamjung, ward 6, Besisahar Municipality (12 Nov 2019)**, retrofitting has not progressed in the ward due to lack of knowledge and proper techniques in retrofitting. Majority of the houses are load bearing stone in mud mortar which lack gable band, and some have 4" partition wall in masonry structures making them non-compliant. Most of the retrofit families have submitted an application to be included in full reconstruction grant list thus, have not started reconstruction.
- In **Nuwakot, Ward 6, Belkotgadhi Municipality (13 Nov 2019)**, the reconstruction progress is reported to be slow with only few households receiving the third tranche. 146 households were included in the resurvey and reverification, but these have not been addressed delaying reconstruction. There is only one household

in retrofit list, but the owner does not want to retrofit as his house is almost completely damaged so wants to be included in the full reconstruction grant list.

- In **Kaski, Wards 4 & 5, Rupakot Rural Municipality (14 Nov 2019) & Wards 1 & 2, Annapurna Rural Municipality**, little progress with retrofitting was noted due to lack of information on retrofitting and lack of skilled masons doing retrofitting. There is a misconception between repair and retrofit, thus many houses have been repaired simply using plaster. It was also reported that many houses were constructed just to meet the NRA deadline Kartik 2076 (mid Nov 2019) resulting in increased non-compliant cases.
- In **Syangja**, interaction programs were held in **Wards 7 & 13, Putalibazar Municipality & Ward 13, Galyang Municipality from 19-21 Nov 2019**. The program was focused on to discuss retrofit related issues and challenges with households under retrofit grant list, to find out the interests of people on retrofitting and to identify the reasons if not interested in retrofitting. Some of the issues that came up during the meeting for not proceeding beyond the first tranche were: people utilized the 50,000 NPR to repair the small hairline cracks in their houses using plaster. Due to the lack of timely information, people simply plastered their house, now they do not have money to further retrofit the houses. Some of the people under retrofit list have demolished the houses due to risk of hazard and have constructed new houses without following technical specifications. Some of the people were also not convinced of the retrofit methods. However, many of the people agreed to retrofit their houses after the interaction program.
- In **Okhaldhunga**, meetings took place in **Ward 4 Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Ward 9 & municipal of Likhu Rural Municipality (11-13 Nov 2019)**. It was decided that local authorities and technical engineers together hold public awareness programs to encourage the people to carry out retrofitting and to facilitate those households who wish to retrofit their houses. Absence of technical staff in ward 4, Sunkoshi RM and change in working area of technical person from ward 9 to ward 1 of Likhu RM were noted. This has been reported to DLPIU Building as well.
- In **Sindhuli, Dudhauri Municipality (12 Nov 2019) & Hariharpurgadhi Rural Municipality (14 Nov 2019)**, decisions were made to collect the details of households in retrofit grant list to find their status and encourage them to start retrofitting. The municipalities raised concern regarding the NRA deadline, Kartik 2076 (mid Nov 2019) for taking the second tranche.
- In **Solukhumbu, Ward 6, Mappe Dudhkoshi Rural Municipality (21 Nov 2019)**, a decision was made to collect the details of households under the retrofit grant list and submit to DLPIU Building, and to hold an interaction program to encourage people to start retrofitting. There were concerns regarding the results of resurvey and reverification which has caused delay in reconstruction and increased confusion among the communities.
- In **Makwanpur, Raksirang Rural Municipality (21 Nov 2019)**, meeting took place at municipal level in presence of representatives from wards 6, 7 & 8. The meeting emphasized on developing an action plan of each ward and its implementation to complete reconstruction within the NRA timeline. It was reported that 40% of the households have received reconstruction completion certificate. Ward offices were requested to plan to finalize the CS Entry, to distribute the completion certificates and start retrofitting.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur and Lalitpur, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019](#)



Ward 2, Changunarayan Municipality, Bhaktapur: two storey RCC structure. The house has 9" x 12" columns, and is thus non-compliant based on Building Code Standard. The house was constructed immediately after the 2015 earthquake. The homeowner has received the first tranche of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019](#)



Ward 3, Temal Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: two storey, stone in cement mortar structure. The house was built after demolishing the quake-damaged house in the same place. The house was designed to fulfill both the residential and business purposes. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction is 18,00,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019



Ward 2, Kageshwori Manohara Municipality, Kathmandu: single storey brick in cement mortar structure with RC slab. The house is non-compliant due to missing bands and beam. The homeowner has received the second tranche of GoN housing grant and has applied for third tranche. District Support Engineer suggested that the homeowner add bands to be eligible for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019



Ward 6, Raksirang Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: four room, stone in mud mortar house. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The homeowner added a top floor after receiving the third tranche, so has not been approved for completion certificate.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019](#)



Ward 6, Myaghang Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: single storey, one room, brick in cement structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

[HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Syangja Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019](#)



Ward 4, Rupakot Rural Municipality, Kaski: two storey, load bearing, stone in mud mortar masonry. The house is under retrofit list. The homeowner has received first tranche of retrofit grant. The house has been repaired using simple plaster without following proper retrofit measures. The family are living in the house.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019](#)



Ward 2, Helambu Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: single storey, two room, load bearing stone in mud mortar house with CGI roofing. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Solukhumbu, Okhaldhunga, Khotang, Monthly Report, 22 Oct – 21 Nov 2019



Ward 5, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga single storey with attic, two room, stone in mud mortar house with RCC bands. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for completion certificate. The total cost of construction is 750,000 NPR.

Case Studies



Featured Technical Staff Person, Shambhu Raj Karna, This month's Bulletin features Mr. Shambhu Raj Karna, technical staff. He is originally from Sarlahi district. He has been working as an Engineer in Manahari Rural Municipality in Makawanpur district since April 2016 and is also a reconstruction focal person at the municipality.

Having worked at Manahari Rural Municipality for more than three and a half years, he has experienced various issues and challenges in the reconstruction work. Most of the houses in Manahari Rural Municipality are made up of timber structure and hollow concrete blocks. There was no

manual/guideline on these structures in the beginning which made it difficult to carry out the inspection and approval processes causing delay in the reconstruction progress. The issue of landlessness was also a major concern of reconstruction in Manahari Rural Municipality. Thanks to the Government of Nepal for having flexible policies to facilitate the process of reconstruction work in such situation said Shambhu.

Despite many challenges, he states that it is only with collaborative efforts of DLPIU GMAI, Local Government and other partner organizations, the reconstruction of private houses is moving well with completion of almost 75% of the houses at Manahari Rural Municipality.

He is not only satisfied to see the reconstruction picking up, but happy to see the increased awareness among the people about the government policy and standards/guidelines for constructing earthquake resistant houses.

However, in the current context, he noted that the main issue is with houses that are under retrofitting grant. "This is the first time that the Government of Nepal is implementing such a large-scale retrofitting project in the country," said Mr. Shambhu, who takes this as an opportunity to learn and share his knowledge and skills in retrofitting. He is

eager to work with the government to retrofit the houses of the poor people. However, the biggest challenge he finds is convincing the people to start retrofitting. He states that lack of adequate financial resources has been the main problem to the already poor people, with only 1,00,000 NPR government retrofitting grants being given to the households. This amount is simply not enough to carry out the retrofitting tasks even to the minimum said Shambu.

Shambu is also leading a Retrofit Task Force at Manahari Rural Municipality. He views that proper procedural design on retrofitting, and training on retrofitting to the technical persons would help to move retrofitting initiatives in a smooth way.

Shambhu Karna considers himself lucky to be part of the earthquake reconstruction programme where he has not only gained technical experience, but also developed his management skills. He is determined to put his effort and contribute to achieving a shared vision of “Build Back Better”, which he feels is not only a slogan but is also emotionally attached to everyone working in reconstruction.

Prem Nagarkoti, Retrofit Beneficiary: Mr. Prem Nagarkoti is a resident of Aalapot Ward No. 1, Kageshwori Manohara Municipality, Kathmandu. Prem is 24 years old. His house is a two-storey load bearing adobe (mud brick) house with mud mortar and an attic constructed 17 years ago in 2059 B.S. The front section has standard bricks while the rest of the section of the walls have adobe with mud mortar. The 2015 earthquake partially damaged the house leaving cracks, and the house was enlisted in the Retrofitting Grant list. Prem lives with his single mother and a sister. As the legal custodian of the house, Prem is registered as the beneficiary, but his mother is the de facto household head. So, he cannot alone make the decision whereas his mother does not feel confident in pursuing the retrofitting option. The family has done some minor repairing using mud plaster and continue living in the house. However, the house does not have any earthquake resistant elements, and Prem and his family are willing to retrofit their house following proper retrofitting measures. They have not been able to start as they are not able to afford the materials and other costs for retrofitting.

Prem has not signed the partnership agreement with the Government. “If we got the tranche and did not retrofit the house, instead use the money for other purposes and if we are asked to return the amount, it would be more difficult,” said Prem.

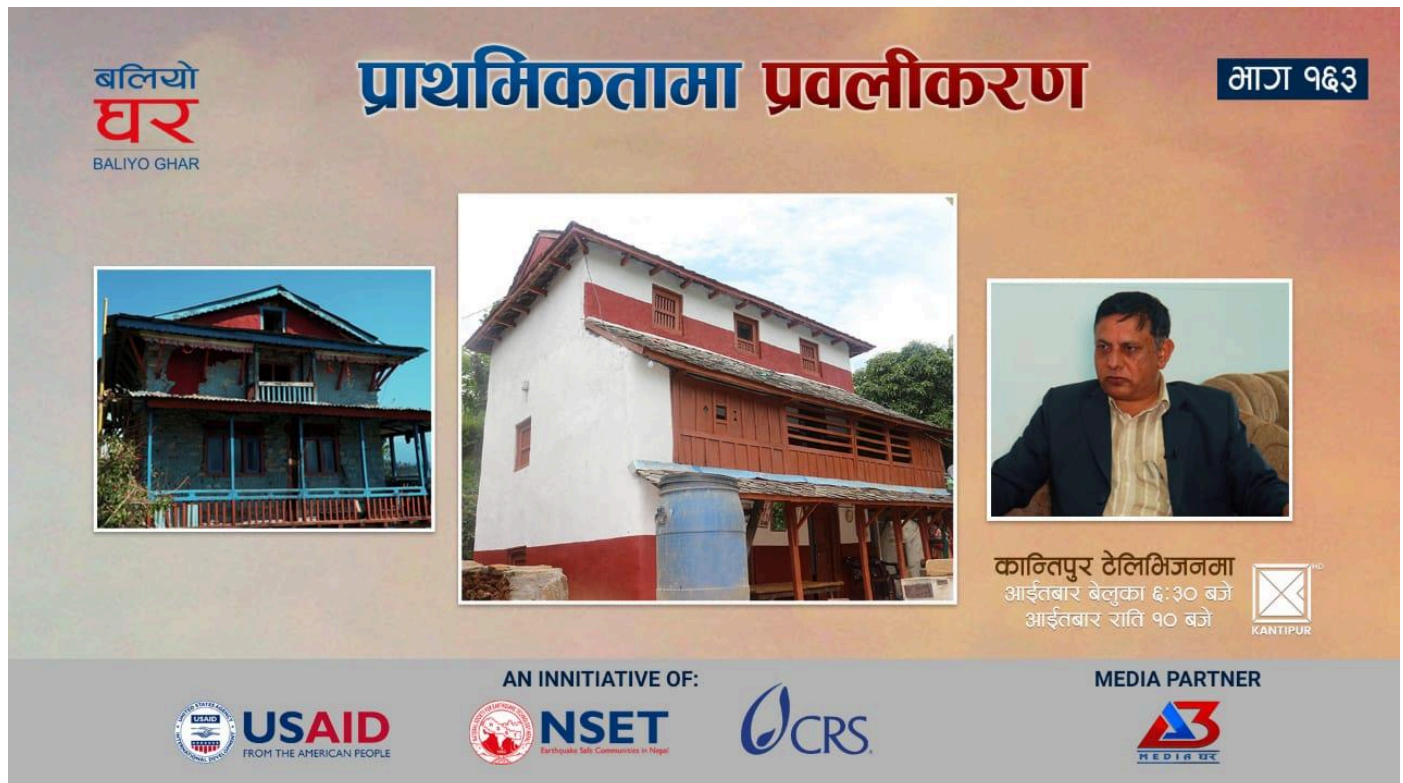


Front view of the damaged house



Isometric view of the house

Media coverage and communication on Reconstruction



बलियो घर
BALIYO GHAR

प्राथमिकतामा प्रवर्लीकरण

भाग १६३

कान्तिपुर टेलिभिजनमा
आइतबार बेलुका ६:३० बजे
आइतबार राति १० बजे

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Earthquake Safe Communities in Nepal

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[Baliyo Ghar | Episode -163 | 24 November 2019](#): NRA Executive Committee Member, Dr. Hariram Parajuli highlights the effectiveness of applying retrofitting techniques based on the NRA guidelines and procedures. This program was aired in Kantipur Television on 24 November 2019 at 7:00 PM. Kantipur TV airs this program every Sunday at 6:30 PM and Monday at 11:30 AM and 4:00 PM.

[Publication Kathamala Radio Drama:Episode One- House of Kala](#)

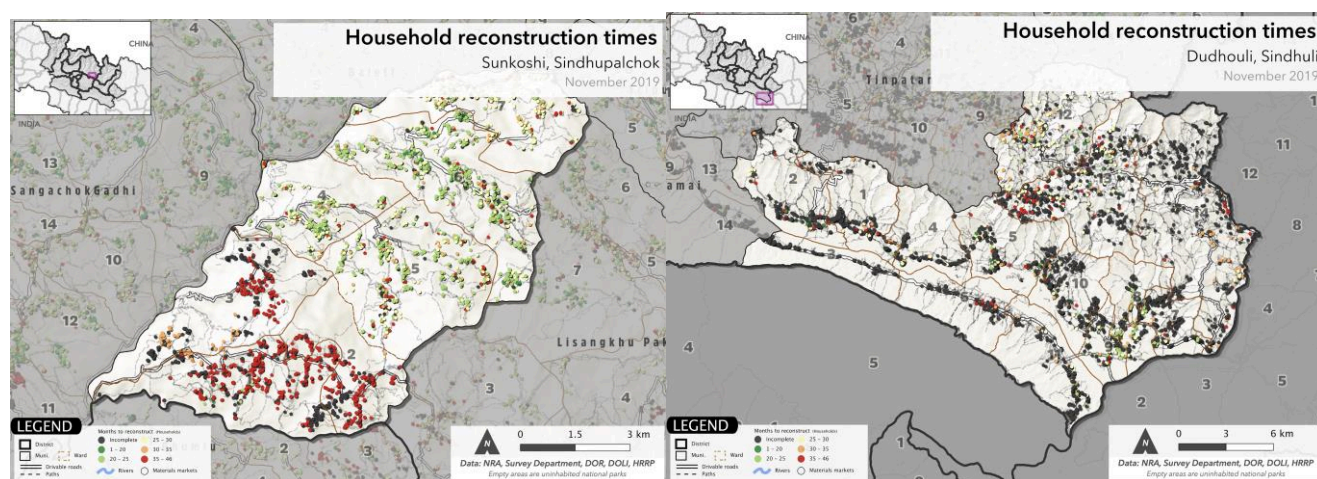
Two little girls, Seema and Kala are playing together in the front yard of Seema's newly built house. They soon get into an argument about the score of their *chungu* game. Seema tells Kala to go back to her "damaged house" and says she would never come to her house to play, because it is damaged. The incident scars Kala and she begins to sleep talk about the condition of their house. This prompts her parents into the decision of retrofitting their house. After retrofitting, Kala's house becomes as good as new, as well as safe. The story ends with the two friends reconciling and playing together again.

National Products

[Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority- October 2019](#)

HRRP Products

Household reconstruction times: The municipal level maps of household reconstruction progress based on the NRA's inspection data as of November 16th, 2019. These maps showing the time taken for households to complete reconstruction can be useful for targeted aid to speed up the reconstruction for families still reconstructing by additional assistance or follow-up in areas where reconstruction lagged, and identification of what went right in municipalities where reconstruction was swift. Huge thanks to Robert Banick, HRRP volunteer, for putting the effort to prepare these maps. [Please access the links here.](#)



Reconstruction and Retrofitting information pack highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month. [Please access the links here.](#)

Palika Profiles (Municipal reconstruction profiles): HRRP has developed reconstruction and recovery profiles for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are responsible for updating the profiles on a monthly basis with support from HRRP. Municipal reconstruction profiles for all the earthquake-affected municipalities can be accessed from this link: <http://bit.ly/palikaprofiles>

Municipal dataset on Reconstruction: A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as [CSV](#) and [PDF](#). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

Partner Products

[Good Practice Review \(GPR\)](#): This document is part of a series of learning products developed in partnership with the Global Alliance for Urban Crises. The Alliance, launched at the World Humanitarian Summit in 2016, is a global, multi-disciplinary and collaborative community of practice. It brings together officials from local government, built environment professionals, academics and humanitarian and development actors to work towards systemic change in the way we enable cities and urban communities to prevent, prepare for and respond to urban crises. For more on the Alliance visit www.urbancrises.org.

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CONTACT US

HRRP Nepal Office

Jawagal, Lalitpur, Nepal

Tel: (+977) - 01 - 5544149

Email: info@hrrpnepal.org